

1. Manuscript Preparation and Submission

Manuscripts must be prepared using the **official LaTeX template** available on the journal website. Only submissions prepared with the provided LaTeX template will be considered.

The manuscript must be written in **English**. Submissions in **Portuguese** are accepted only for undergraduate student papers. Original Research Articles should not exceed **8 pages**, including the abstract, figures, tables, references, and all manuscript content. Supplementary material, if any, must be submitted separately as a **single PDF file** and is not included in the page limit.

One member of the group must be designated as the **corresponding author**. The corresponding author is responsible for submitting the manuscript through the journal's **online submission system** by the deadline (**D1**). Manuscripts submitted after the deadline or by any means other than the online submission system (e.g., email or cloud storage links) will not be considered.

Before submission, the corresponding author must create an account on the journal website. Since the system does not provide a password recovery option, authors are strongly encouraged to choose and securely store a password that can be easily retrieved later. Once the account has been created, log in and select **New Submission** to begin the submission process.

1.1. Manuscript type and details

During submission, the corresponding author should select **"Original Article"**, unless a different manuscript type has been specified by the course instructor.

The corresponding author must then provide the **Full Title** of the manuscript. The title should follow **sentence case**, with only the first letter of the first word and proper nouns capitalized. The title entered into the submission system must be **identical** to the title appearing in the manuscript.

Authors must also provide a **Running Head**, which is a shortened version of the manuscript title. If the full title contains **60 characters or fewer (including spaces)**, it may be used as the running head without modification.

Finally, authors must provide **at least three keywords**, separated by commas. Keywords should be written in **sentence case**, with only the first letter of the first word capitalized (unless proper nouns are used). The keywords entered into the submission system must exactly match those listed in the manuscript.

1.2. Authors

The corresponding author must provide the **full name**, **institutional affiliation**, and **e-mail address** of all coauthors.

For the purposes of this educational activity, all members of the group are expected to contribute substantially to the manuscript. Although the corresponding author and first author may have different responsibilities during manuscript preparation and submission, all coauthors are expected to participate equally in the development of the study and manuscript.

The corresponding author should be identified by selecting the **star icon** displayed next to the author's name. This author will be responsible for handling all correspondence with the journal, including the initial submission, revisions, and final publication procedures.

1.3. Abstract and details

Provide the manuscript **Abstract** exactly as it appears in the submitted manuscript. The abstract is mandatory and must not exceed **300 words**. It should be written as a **single paragraph** and briefly describe the study objectives, methodology, principal findings, and main conclusions. References, citations, undefined abbreviations, and equations should not be included in the abstract.

Below the abstract, provide **three to five Highlights** in the form of concise bullet points. Each highlight should summarize one of the principal contributions or findings of the manuscript and should not exceed **85 characters**, including spaces.

Although this journal is intended primarily as an educational exercise, authors should present their results as they would in a professional scientific publication. Each highlight should emphasize the novelty or significance of the work, whether it consists of a new observation, methodological improvement, dataset, analysis, or interpretation. Contributions do not need to represent major scientific breakthroughs; however, they should clearly demonstrate an original contribution within the scope of the study, even if it is limited to a specific site, region, dataset, or experimental condition.

The submission system also provides an option to **suggest potential reviewers**. This field is **optional** for this activity and may be left blank.

1.4. Upload files and LaTeX structure

For the **initial submission**, authors must upload **only the compiled PDF** generated from the official LaTeX template. The manuscript must include **continuous line numbering**; therefore, the `\linenumbers` command **must remain active** (i.e., it should not be commented out). At this stage, **LaTeX source files are not required**.

Authors may optionally submit **Supplementary Material** as a **single PDF file**. Supplementary material may include additional figures, tables, datasets, derivations, or explanatory text that support the manuscript but are not essential for understanding its main findings. All supplementary items must be cited in the main text. The manuscript should remain complete and understandable without consulting the supplementary material.

Original Research Articles must include the following sections, where applicable:

- Title
- Abstract
- Keywords
- Introduction
- Materials and Methods
- Results
- Discussion
- Conclusion
- Author Contributions
- Artificial Intelligence Statement (if applicable)
- References

Authors **must not modify** the provided .cls file or any portions of the .tex template explicitly identified as non-editable. Only the designated sections of the manuscript should be edited.

All figure files must be stored in a folder named **images** and named sequentially according to their order of appearance in the manuscript (e.g., Fig1.png, Fig2.pdf, Fig3.jpg). Figures should be of publication quality and have a minimum resolution of **300 dpi**.

An **Author Contributions** section is mandatory for all submissions. This section should briefly describe the contribution of each author to the study (e.g., conceptualization, methodology, formal analysis, writing, supervision, or funding acquisition).

If artificial intelligence (AI) tools (e.g., ChatGPT, Copilot, Gemini, Claude, or similar systems) were used during the preparation of the manuscript, authors must include an **Artificial Intelligence Statement** describing how these tools were used. The statement should specify the purpose of AI use (e.g., language editing, code generation, literature summarization, or brainstorming) and clarify that the authors remain fully responsible for the accuracy, originality, and integrity of the manuscript.

Following the initial submission, manuscripts will undergo the journal's peer-review process as part of the course assessment. Authors will receive reviewers' comments and will be required to prepare a revised version of the manuscript together with a detailed **Response to Reviewers** document addressing each comment individually.

Status	Grade
Accepted	> 98
Minor revision.	90 – 98
Major revision	40 – 90
Rejected	< 40

Throughout the peer-review process, authors **will not have access to their numerical grade**. The submission system will display only the **editorial decision** (e.g., *Accepted*, *Minor Revision*, *Major Revision*, or *Rejected*) and the reviewers' comments.

If a manuscript receives a decision of **Accepted** or **Rejected**, the peer-review process is considered complete, and no further revisions may be submitted. Consequently, the assigned grade cannot be modified.

If the manuscript receives a decision of **Minor Revision** or **Major Revision**, authors will be invited to submit a revised version of the manuscript by the **final deadline**. The revised submission must include both a revised manuscript and a **Response to Reviewers** document. The response letter should address **each reviewer comment individually**, indicating how the manuscript was revised or providing a clear justification whenever a suggestion was not incorporated. All modifications made to the manuscript should be clearly identified.

Following resubmission, the manuscript will undergo a second evaluation. Depending on the quality of the revisions, the final grade may increase or decrease by **up to 30%** relative to the initial evaluation. For example, a manuscript that initially receives a blinded grade of **70** and a decision of **Major Revision** may receive a final grade ranging from **49 to 91**, depending on the quality of the revised manuscript and the accompanying response letter.

1.5. Files Required for a Revised Submission

The corresponding author will have access to the reviewers' comments through the online submission system. Before uploading the revised files, the previously submitted manuscript should be **removed** from the submission.

A revised submission must include the following files:

1. **main.tex**, containing the complete revised manuscript (only the main .tex file).
2. **A clean PDF** of the revised manuscript with **line numbering disabled** (\linenumbers commented out).
3. **A marked-up PDF** highlighting all modifications made since the previous version. Deleted text should appear as `\textcolor{red}{\sout{deleted text}}`, while newly added text should appear as `\textcolor{red}{added text}`.
4. **The .bib bibliography file.**
5. **A Response to Reviewers** document explaining how each reviewer comment was addressed.
6. **All figure files** in their original formats.
7. **Any Supplementary Material**, if applicable.

2. Manuscript Preparation Tips

The following recommendations apply to all **Original Research Articles**. Authors are encouraged to use this checklist before submitting their manuscripts.

Manuscript Length

Although the maximum manuscript length is **8 pages**, a well-balanced **7-page** manuscript is generally organized as follows:

- **Introduction:** approximately 1 page
- **Materials and Methods:** approximately 2 pages
- **Results:** approximately 2 pages
- **Discussion:** approximately 1.5 pages
- **Conclusion:** approximately 0.5 page

These proportions are intended only as a guideline and may vary depending on the nature of the study.

Introduction

The Introduction should be concise and should **not contain subheadings**. It should provide sufficient background to place the study in context, identify the knowledge gap addressed by the research, and clearly state the study objectives or hypotheses. Avoid an extensive literature review or a summary of the study results.

Materials and Methods

The Materials and Methods section should provide sufficient detail to enable the study to be reproduced by other researchers. Previously published methods should be described briefly and cited appropriately, while any modifications or newly developed methods should be described in detail.

Results

Present the findings clearly and objectively without interpreting their significance. Results should be supported by appropriately referenced figures and tables and organized into logical subsections whenever appropriate.

Discussion

The Discussion should interpret the results in the context of previous studies, explain their scientific significance, discuss limitations, and highlight the implications of the findings. Avoid simply repeating the results. Although the **Results** and **Discussion** sections may be combined, the journal **strongly recommends presenting them as separate sections**.

Conclusion

The Conclusion should summarize the principal findings and their implications without repeating the Discussion. No new results, references, or interpretations should be introduced in this section.

Figures

Ensure that every figure is cited in the text in numerical order and accompanied by a descriptive caption. Figure captions should be placed **below the figure** and should include a concise title together with sufficient information to understand the illustration without referring extensively to the main text. All symbols, abbreviations, and units should be explained either in the figure or in the caption.

Tables

Tables should be prepared as **editable text** rather than images. Each table must have a concise title, be cited in the text in numerical order, and present information that complements rather than duplicates the manuscript text. Excessively large tables should be included as **Supplementary Material** whenever appropriate.

References

Ensure that every reference cited in the text appears in the reference list, and that every reference listed has been cited in the manuscript. References should follow the journal formatting style provided in the LaTeX template.

Language

Authors are encouraged to write in clear, concise, and grammatically correct English. Avoid unnecessarily long sentences, colloquial expressions, and excessive use of passive voice whenever a more direct construction improves readability.